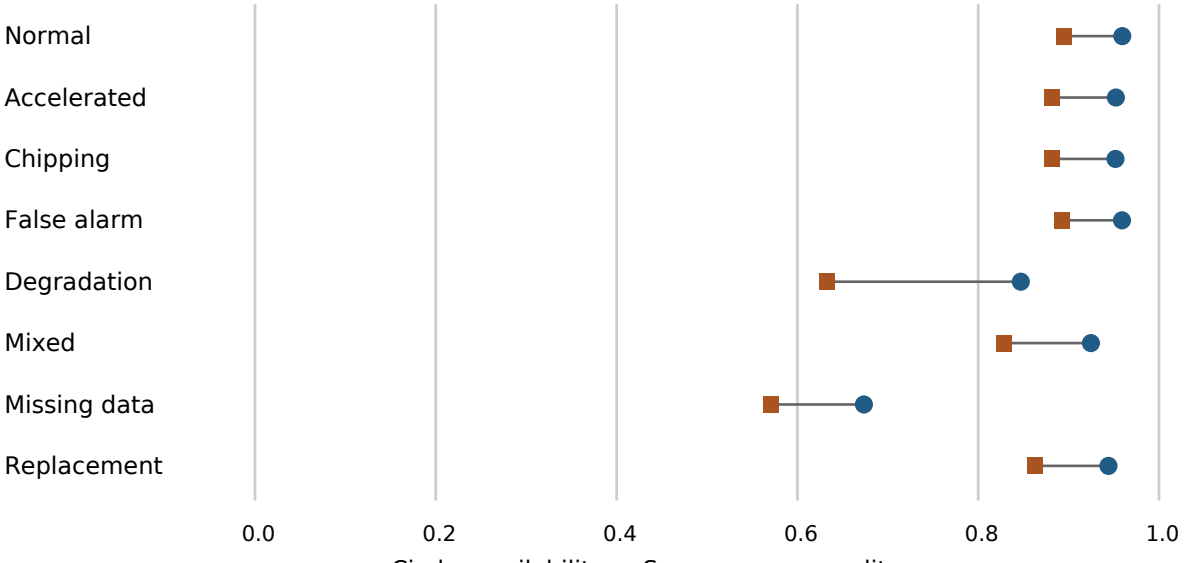Channel availability and mean quality